

but didn't she? "And if you have not been faithful in the use of that which is another's, who will give you that which is your own?" (Luke 16:12)

It has been estimated that the cost of hospital and medical care might be reduced by half if Americans could not fall back on their insurance to pay the bills. Satan is very subtle about the traps he lays for us. Rarely will a knowledgeable Christian be tricked into an overt act of sin. So Satan provides a small, almost inconsequential, compromise to God's standard, such as shifting a personal obligation off to an insurance company.

CURRENT ATTITUDES

Why is it that even committed Christians are tempted to cheat and rationalize their dealings with insurance companies? Several factors are involved: one is that insurance companies are seemingly wealthy and impersonal. Inwardly, many people feel that to be wealthy, they must be dishonest and, therefore, are "fair game."

Also, since they don't actually know anyone at the insurance company, it's not like cheating a person.

Lastly, we have developed such a "protectionist" attitude in our society that most Christians are expecting too much from insurance. Literally, they expect the insurance company to "protect" them from any loss.

Some people feel that their insurance payments entitle them to cumulative benefits, so that if they have paid in for 5 years at \$200 a year for home insurance, they have at least \$1,000 in benefits coming. Others somehow believe that, because insurance pays the bill (and often their company pays the insurance), the benefits are free. The reality that such coverage is not free is beginning to be made very clear as companies cut back on benefits, including paid insurance, to survive financially.

BIBLICAL PERSPECTIVE

A Christian must believe (act in accordance) that *all* resources belong to God. Therefore, the resources that are in the con-